Terms of Reference: Widow Vocational Training Program — Cohort 1

Reference: ADA/2022/002 **Organization:** Apoti Development Association (ADA) **Duration:** March 1 – September 30, 2022 (6 months) **Location:** Bamenda, North-West Region, Cameroon **Budget:** 1,800,000 CFA (~$3,000 USD)

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1. Background and Context

The Anglophone crisis in Cameroon's North-West Region has left hundreds of women widowed, many with dependent children and no source of income. In Bamenda, these widows face compounded vulnerabilities: loss of spousal income, displacement, social stigma, and lack of marketable skills. Without intervention, they remain trapped in cycles of poverty and dependence.

The Apoti Development Association (ADA), a faith-based organization supporting vulnerable communities since 2021, identified vocational training as the most sustainable pathway to economic independence for these women. This program represents ADA's first long-term intervention, designed to move beyond emergency relief toward permanent self-sufficiency.

2. Program Objective

Overall Goal: Enable 15 widows in Bamenda to achieve economic self-sufficiency through vocational skills acquisition in tailoring and hairdressing.

Specific Objectives:

1. Provide 6 months of structured vocational training in tailoring and hairdressing
2. Equip graduates with starter kits to immediately begin income-generating activities
3. Provide monthly stipends to remove financial barriers to participation
4. Achieve a minimum 80% graduation rate with demonstrated competency
5. Ensure at least 70% of graduates earn independent income within 3 months of completion

3. Target Beneficiaries

- **Number:** 15 widows
- **Profile:** Women who lost husbands to Anglophone crisis violence
- **Location:** Bamenda and surrounding communities, North-West Region
- **Selection Criteria:**
  - Widowed due to crisis-related violence
  - No current stable income source
  - Demonstrated motivation and commitment to complete 6-month program
  - Ability to attend daily training sessions
  - Priority given to women with dependent children

4. Program Activities

Phase 1: Recruitment and Orientation (March 2022)

- Community outreach and beneficiary identification
- Selection interviews and needs assessment
- Program orientation and expectation setting

- Baseline income and skills assessment

Phase 2: Core Training (March – August 2022)

- **Tailoring Track:** Pattern cutting, machine operation, garment construction, alterations, and finishing
- **Hairdressing Track:** Hair washing, styling, braiding, chemical treatments, and salon management
- Practical hands-on training 5 days per week
- Monthly progress assessments
- Business skills integration (pricing, customer service, record-keeping)

Phase 3: Graduation and Launch (September 2022)

- Final competency assessments
- Distribution of starter kits (sewing machines, hair tools, initial supplies)
- Graduation ceremony
- Post-graduation mentorship plan

Cross-Cutting Activities

- Monthly stipend disbursement (8,000 CFA per beneficiary)
- Provision of training materials and supplies
- Psychosocial support and peer group sessions
- Business mentorship and market linkage

5. Implementation Team

Role	Number	Responsibility
Vocational Instructors	2	Daily training delivery (1 tailoring, 1 hairdressing)
ADA Coordinators	4	Program management, monitoring, beneficiary support

6. Budget Summary

Line Item	Amount (CFA)
Instructor fees (2 × 6 months × 40,000/month)	480,000
Training materials and supplies	300,000
Monthly stipends (15 × 8,000 × 6 months)	720,000
Starter kits (15 × 15,000)	225,000
Venue rental (6 months × 10,000)	60,000
Transport and coordination	50,000
Graduation ceremony	30,000
Contingency	35,000
Total	**1,900,000**

Approved Budget: 1,800,000 CFA (~$3,000 USD)

7. Expected Outcomes

- 15 widows enrolled and trained in marketable vocational skills
- Minimum 12 graduates (80% completion rate)
- At least 10 graduates earning independent income within 3 months
- Minimum 2 small businesses launched by graduates
- Measurable income increase among participants
- Replicable model for future cohorts

8. Monitoring and Evaluation

- Monthly attendance tracking
- Quarterly skills assessments
- Pre/post income surveys
- 3-month and 6-month post-graduation follow-up
- Beneficiary satisfaction surveys
- Financial expenditure tracking and reporting

9. Risks and Mitigation

Risk	Likelihood	Mitigation
Security disruptions (crisis-related)	Medium	Flexible scheduling, safe venue selection
Beneficiary dropout	Medium	Stipends, psychosocial support, peer groups
Instructor unavailability	Low	Backup instructor identification
Material supply disruption	Low	Advance procurement, local sourcing

10. Sustainability

- Graduates equipped with tools and skills for immediate income generation
- Business skills training enables independent operation
- Peer support networks for ongoing mutual assistance
- Success model informs future ADA programming (Cohort 2+)
- Community awareness of program creates referral pipeline

Prepared by: ADA Program Team **Date:** February 2022 **Approved by:** ADA Executive Director